



CLOUDKART

Shipping Policy

Shipping & Orders Knowledge Base

Defines CloudKart's shipping methods, costs, order lifecycle, international customs handling, address changes, and order tracking for physical merchandise.

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1. Overview

CloudKart ships physical merchandise — including branded hardware accessories and promotional items purchased through the CloudKart Store — to customers worldwide. This document defines shipping methods, costs, timelines, and international handling so that support agents and the chatbot can answer order-status questions accurately.

Scope Note

This policy covers physical merchandise only. Digital products and subscriptions are delivered instantly upon purchase and are not subject to shipping timelines.

Physical orders made through the CloudKart Store are separate from digital subscription orders. A customer may have both a digital subscription invoice and a physical merchandise order; agents should confirm which order the customer is asking about before applying policy, since the documents governing each are entirely different.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer asks about their 'order' without specifying what it is.

Resolution: Ask whether it's a physical item from the CloudKart Store or a digital subscription — the answer determines which policy applies.

Scenario: Customer has a digital Pro subscription and also ordered a branded hoodie.

Resolution: Two separate orders; confirm which one they're asking about before looking up status or applying shipping vs. billing policy.

2. Shipping Methods and Costs

Customers choose a shipping method at checkout. Available methods and estimated timelines vary by destination region.

Method	Domestic	International	Cost
Standard	3–5 business days	7–14 business days	\$4.99; free over \$50
Express	1–2 business days	3–6 business days	\$14.99
Same-Day (select cities)	Same day if before 11 AM	Not available	\$24.99

Business days exclude weekends and CloudKart's recognised public holidays, published annually on the Shipping Information page. Estimated timelines begin from the order's processing completion, not from the order placement timestamp. During peak shopping seasons (November–December), actual transit times may run 1–2 business days longer than the estimates above due to carrier volume.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer placed a Standard order on Friday at 3 PM and expects delivery by Monday.

Resolution: Standard domestic is 3–5 business days from processing; placed Friday afternoon means processing likely starts Monday, making the earliest delivery Thursday.

Scenario: Customer in Lagos asks for Same-Day delivery.

Resolution: Same-Day is available in select cities only; confirm Lagos is not currently a supported city and offer Express international instead.

3. Order Lifecycle Stages

Orders go through a short processing period before they ship, during which the warehouse picks, packs, and labels the order.

- 1 **Order Placed:** Confirmation email sent immediately.
- 2 **Processing:** Typically 1–2 business days; orders placed after 2 PM local warehouse time begin processing the next business day.
- 3 **Shipped:** Tracking number generated and emailed to the customer.
- 4 **In Transit:** Carrier updates appear on the tracking page; this stage takes the bulk of the estimated delivery window.
- 5 **Delivered:** Carrier marks the package delivered; customer receives a delivery confirmation email.

Orders containing items from multiple warehouses may ship in separate packages with separate tracking numbers, arriving on different days. This is expected behaviour, not an error. The order confirmation email lists which items are shipping from which warehouse when this applies.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer ordered 3 items; only 2 have shipped — they think one is lost.

Resolution: Check whether the remaining item is shipping from a separate warehouse; if so, a second tracking number will be generated separately within 1–2 business days.

Scenario: Customer's order is still in 'Processing' after 3 business days.

Resolution: Check for an inventory hold or payment verification flag on the order in the Order Console — either can silently pause processing.

4. International Shipping and Customs

CloudKart ships to over 60 countries. International orders may be subject to customs duties, import taxes, or brokerage fees imposed by the destination country, which are not included in the CloudKart checkout price.

Important

Customs duties and import taxes are the responsibility of the recipient and are collected by the carrier or local customs authority, not CloudKart. Agents should never promise duty-free delivery for any international order.

Some countries restrict import of certain item categories; if an order is held or returned by customs, the customer is responsible for resulting return shipping costs unless the item was incorrectly classified by CloudKart's fulfillment system, in which case CloudKart covers the cost.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer in Germany received a €22 customs invoice from DHL.

Resolution: Customs duties are the customer's responsibility; explain that CloudKart's checkout does not pre-collect EU VAT for non-threshold orders.

Scenario: Customer's order was returned to CloudKart by customs.

Resolution: Check the return reason; if it was due to incorrect classification by CloudKart's system, re-ship at no charge. If restricted item, explain and offer a refund.

5. Changing a Shipping Address

Customers can update the shipping address on an order only before the order enters the 'Shipped' status. Once a tracking number is generated, the address cannot be changed by CloudKart directly.

- 1 If still in **Processing**: customer can edit the address themselves from Order History > View Order > Edit Shipping Address.
- 2 If **Shipped**: address changes must be requested directly with the carrier using the tracking number; CloudKart support can provide carrier contact information but cannot make the change.
- 3 If the carrier cannot redirect the package and it returns to the warehouse as undeliverable, see Section 6 for next steps.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer realises they used an old address right after placing an order.

Resolution: If still in Processing, guide them to Order History > Edit Shipping Address immediately — they can self-serve this before the label is generated.

Scenario: Order has shipped to the wrong address and customer wants it rerouted.

Resolution: Provide the carrier's customer service number and tracking number; advise the customer to call the carrier directly as CloudKart can't intercept in-transit packages.

6. Undeliverable and Returned-to-Sender Packages

Packages are occasionally returned to the CloudKart warehouse by the carrier, most often due to an incomplete address, refused delivery, or repeated failed delivery attempts.

Return Reason	Customer Option
Incomplete or incorrect address	Re-ship with corrected address (shipping fee applies) or refund
Refused at delivery	Refund only; re-shipping refused packages is not offered
Failed delivery attempts (recipient unavailable)	Re-ship to a different address or pickup point, or refund
Package damaged in transit, returned by carrier	Re-ship at no charge or refund, customer's choice

Worked Examples

Scenario: Carrier returned a package because the apartment number was missing.

Resolution: Offer re-shipment with the corrected address; a standard shipping fee applies unless it was CloudKart's error at the label stage.

Scenario: Customer refused delivery because the outer box was visibly damaged.

Resolution: Treat as a damaged-item case; re-ship at no charge or refund, customer's choice.

7. Order Tracking

Every shipped order includes a tracking number sent by email and viewable in Order History. Tracking is provided by the carrier and reflects scans performed as the package moves through their network.

- Tracking information can take up to 24 hours to appear after a label is generated; this is normal and not a sign of a lost package.
- If tracking shows no movement for more than 5 business days (domestic) or 10 business days (international), treat as a potential delivery issue.
- Customers without a CloudKart account who ordered as a guest can track orders using the order ID and email from their confirmation at cloudkart.com/track.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer received a tracking number 18 hours ago but the carrier site shows nothing.

Resolution: Normal — carrier tracking can take up to 24 hours to activate after label generation; advise the customer to check again tomorrow.

Scenario: Guest customer lost their confirmation email and can't access tracking.

Resolution: They need the order ID from the confirmation email; if they've genuinely lost it, they'll need to contact support with proof of purchase to retrieve the order ID.

8. Common Shipping Questions

This section addresses the most common shipping-related questions seen in support.

Q: Why has my order not shipped yet?

A: Orders typically leave Processing within 1–2 business days. If this window has passed, check for an inventory hold or payment verification flag on the order in the Order Console before escalating, since either can silently pause processing.

Q: Can I combine two separate orders into one shipment?

A: No — orders cannot be merged once placed, even if placed minutes apart. Each order is processed and shipped independently.

Q: Do you ship to PO boxes?

A: Standard shipping supports PO boxes; Express and Same-Day require a physical street address since their carriers don't deliver to PO boxes.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer's order is in Processing for 4 business days with no update.

Resolution: Check for an inventory hold in the Order Console — common when an item is temporarily out of stock at the primary warehouse but available at another.

Scenario: Customer used a PO box address and selected Express shipping.

Resolution: Express cannot deliver to PO boxes; if the order hasn't shipped, offer to update the address to a street address before the label is generated.

9. Quick Reference: Shipping Triage

This quick reference maps common shipping question patterns to the correct document and action, for rapid triage by agents and the chatbot.

Customer Question Pattern	Document	Key Action
'Why hasn't my order shipped?'	shipping_policy.pdf	Check Order Console for inventory hold or payment flag
'Can I change my address?'	shipping_policy.pdf Sec 5	Check if still in Processing; if shipped, contact carrier
'My package was sent back'	shipping_policy.pdf Sec 6	Confirm reason; offer re-ship or refund per return reason table
'How do I track my order?'	shipping_policy.pdf Sec 7	Provide tracking number from Order History or confirm email sent
'Will I pay customs?'	shipping_policy.pdf Sec 4	Inform customer customs are their responsibility; cannot be predicted

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer asks for an ETA and their tracking shows 'In Transit'.

Resolution: Check the tracking page's estimated delivery date from the carrier; if no ETA is shown, use the shipping method's standard window from Section 2.

Scenario: Agent uncertain whether a processing delay is normal or a system issue.

Resolution: 1–2 business days is normal; beyond that, check for holds in the Order Console before assuring the customer everything is fine.

Appendix A: Order Status Labels

Order status labels as shown in the customer-facing Order History page.

Status Label	Meaning
Order Placed	Payment confirmed, awaiting processing
Processing	Warehouse picking and packing the order
Shipped	Tracking number generated, package handed to carrier
In Transit	Package moving through carrier network
Out for Delivery	Package on final-mile vehicle for delivery today
Delivered	Carrier confirms successful delivery
Exception	Carrier-reported issue; see Delivery Issues document